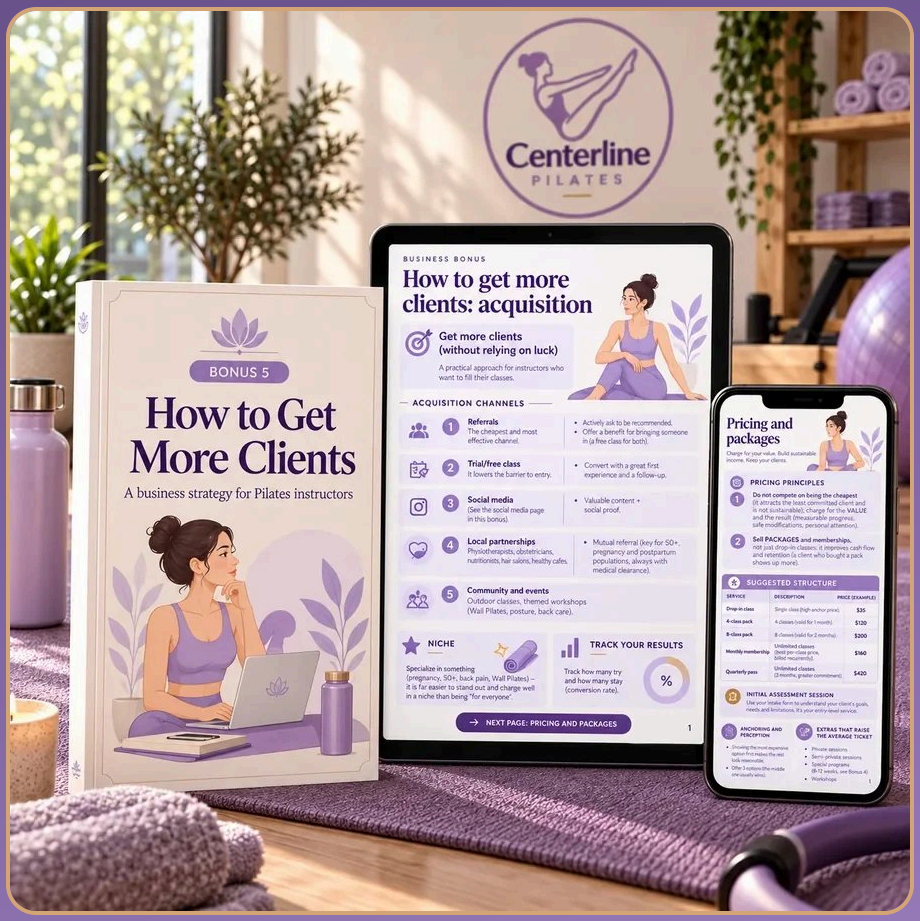
CENTERLINE

PILATES

BONUS 5 OF 5

How to Get More Clients

The business side, for instructors



> *Teaching a great class and building a client base are two different skills. This bonus covers the second one: a practical, honest plan for finding, converting and keeping clients as a Pilates instructor.*

1. An Honest Mindset

Nobody can promise you a specific income or client count. What you earn depends on your local market, the hours you can commit, your teaching, your consistency and plain timing. This guide gives you a structure and tools. It does not give you guarantees, and anyone who offers guarantees is selling something.

> **Set realistic expectations**
> Most instructors build a client base slowly, over months rather than weeks. Expect a few quiet stretches. Track your effort (messages sent, trial classes taught, follow-ups made) as well as your results, because effort is the part you control.

Three principles will carry you through the rest of this guide:

- **Be useful first.** People hire the instructor who clearly helps them move better, not the one who talks the loudest.
- **Be consistent.** Ten small actions a week beat one big push every few months.
- **Be specific.** A clear promise to a clear person is easier to remember and to refer than a general offer to everyone.

2. Your Niche and Value Proposition

A niche is simply the group of people you are best placed to help. Choosing one does not mean turning everyone else away. It means that when someone from that group looks for help, your name comes to mind first.

Examples of niches

- **Prenatal and postnatal:** clients who want gentle, well-adapted movement and an instructor who knows when to modify and when to refer to their health professional.
- **50 plus:** clients who want to stay strong, steady on their feet and confident in daily life.
- **Athletes:** runners, golfers, climbers and others who want mobility, core control and balance work to support their sport.
- **Healthy back focus:** desk workers who want to understand posture, spinal movement and sensible core work (always within your scope and with their clinician's guidance for any pain or injury).
- **Busy professionals:** short, efficient sessions at lunchtime or early morning.

Choosing yours

1. List the people you already enjoy working with and understand.
2. List the experience you have: past careers, sports, life stages, languages, workplaces.

3. Check demand: how many people in your area fit this group, and who already serves them?
4. Pick one niche to lead with for the next 90 days. You can change it later.

A simple value proposition

Use this fill-in-the-blank sentence and say it out loud until it sounds natural:

> **Value proposition template**
>
> I help [type of client] who struggle with [specific frustration] to [specific, realistic outcome] through [your style of class], in [format and place].

Example: *I help new moms ease back into core and pelvic-floor-friendly movement through small-group Pilates mat classes at a local community center.* Notice it describes the experience, not a medical result.

3. Pricing and Packages

How to calculate your rate

Do not copy the cheapest rate in your area. Work out what you need, then compare it with the market. Start with your costs and the hours you can realistically bill, remembering that not every working hour is a paid hour: planning, travel, admin, marketing and cleaning all take time.

The table below is a worked example with made-up numbers. Replace them with your own.

STEP	EXAMPLE	YOUR NUMBERS
Monthly income goal (after costs)	$3,000	
Monthly costs (insurance, music license, equipment, travel, software)	$600	
Amount to earn before costs and taxes	$3,600	
Paid hours you can teach per week	15	
Paid weeks per month (allow for holidays and slow weeks)	3.5	
Paid hours per month (15 × 3.5)	52.5	
Minimum hourly rate ($3,600 / 52.5)	about $69	

In this example the instructor would need to average about $69 per paid hour. In a group class, that might be 8 people paying $9 each, or fewer people at a higher price. In private sessions, it might be one client at $69 or more. Taxes are not included in this example. Ask a qualified accountant how to handle taxes where you live.

> **Not a promise**
>
> These numbers are an illustration of the method, not a typical income. Your own market, hours and time decide what is possible.

Packages and memberships

- **Single session:** your highest per-class price. It is the right option for trying you out or for occasional visits.
- **5-class pack:** a modest discount, valid for a set period (for example 8 weeks). Good for new clients who are not ready to commit further.
- **10-class pack:** a larger discount, valid for a longer period (for example 12 weeks). Encourages regular attendance.
- **Monthly membership:** a fixed number of classes per month, or unlimited, billed automatically. Gives you predictable income and gives clients a reason to show up.
- **Private session bundles:** 4 or 8 one-to-one sessions with an assessment included.

OPTION	EXAMPLE STRUCTURE	BEST FOR
Drop-in	1 class, pay as you go	First-timers, occasional visitors
5-pack	5 classes, expires in 8 weeks	Testing a routine
10-pack	10 classes, expires in 12 weeks	Regular weekly clients
Membership	4 or 8 classes per month, auto-renew	Committed regulars
Private bundle	4 sessions with initial assessment	Clients with specific goals

Set an expiry on packs and a clear cancellation policy. Write both down and share them before the first payment.

How to talk about price

- State the price calmly, then stop talking. Do not apologize or add a discount unprompted.
- Describe the value first (what the client will get) and the price second.
- Offer two or three options so the decision is about which one, not whether.
- If the price is too high for them, offer a smaller package rather than lowering your rate.

A simple line to use: *The 10-class pack is $[amount], which gives you a weekly class for about ten weeks. If you would like to start smaller, the 5-class pack is $[amount].*

4. Where to Find Clients

Studios and gyms that hire

Many studios and gyms hire instructors on a per-class or contract basis. Look at their schedule, notice which class types are missing, and approach the manager with a specific offer: a trial class, a short list of the class formats you teach, and a few available time slots. Bring your certification details and your insurance certificate (see Section 11).

Community spaces

- **Parks:** outdoor mat classes in good weather. Check your local rules on permits and insurance before you start.
- **Companies:** lunchtime or after-work classes for employee wellness programs. Offer a short trial for a small group.
- **Churches and community centers:** they often have a hall and an audience looking for gentle movement classes.
- **Schools and recreation programs:** after-school or adult-education slots, usually requiring background checks and paperwork.

Working with other instructors

Independent instructors can send you overflow clients, ask you to cover their classes, or share a rental space. Introduce yourself, be generous with cover, and refer clients who fit someone else's specialty better than yours.

Referrals

Referrals are usually the most trusted source of new clients. Section 7 covers a simple referral program.

Google Business Profile and reviews

When people search for Pilates near them, a complete and active Google Business Profile helps them find you. Fill in your service area, class types, hours and a short, clear description. Add a few good photos where you have permission to share them. Ask satisfied clients for honest reviews, and reply politely to each one. Never offer payment for reviews and never write them yourself, as platforms have rules against both.

Social media without posting every day

You do not need a daily posting habit. Choose one or two platforms where your clients spend time and post two or three times a week at most, using a repeatable plan (see the calendar in Section 9). Share short teaching clips, class announcements, client questions answered and behind-the-scenes preparation. Always get written permission before showing clients' faces or names.

> **Quality over frequency**
> Three useful posts a week that clearly explain who you help will usually serve you better than daily posts with no clear message.

Whichever channel you choose, keep a simple tracking sheet with the date, the source, the person's name, what you sent, and what happened next. After a month you will see which sources bring real clients and which only keep you busy, and you can put your limited time where it pays off.

5. A Trial Class That Converts

A trial class is your best sales conversation. Its goals are to make the client feel safe, show that you pay attention, and give them a clear next step. Use this step-by-step script.

1. **Before class:** send a short message with the location, what to wear, what to bring, and a simple health question (see the Client Assessment Form in the Library).
2. **Arrival (5 min):** greet them by name, show them the space, and ask what brought them in and what they hope to get from Pilates.
3. **Screening (3 min):** ask about injuries, pregnancy, surgeries and anything their health professional has told them to avoid. If something needs clearance, refer them to their provider and adapt conservatively.
4. **Class (40 min):** keep it simple. Use clear cues, offer one adaptation for each exercise, and give each person personal feedback at least twice. Do not overwhelm a first-timer with advanced work.
5. **Closing (5 min):** ask how their body feels and what they noticed. Reflect back what you saw in their movement, in positive and specific terms.
6. **The offer (5 min):** recommend one next step: a pack, a membership, or a follow-up session. State the price clearly and offer to book it now.
7. **After class:** send a thank-you message within 24 hours (see the templates in Section 8).

> **Close with a recommendation, not pressure**
>
> Say what you recommend and why. If they are not ready, agree on a date to follow up.

Handling common objections

- **It is too expensive.** Acknowledge it, restate what they get, and offer a smaller package. Avoid cutting your rate on the spot.
- **I need to think about it.** Agree, then set a specific follow-up date: *Of course. Shall I check in with you on Thursday?*
- **I am not flexible enough.** Reassure them: Pilates meets you where you are, and you will adapt every exercise to their body.
- **I have an injury.** Ask them to confirm with their health professional first, then offer conservative adaptations within your scope.

A weekly rhythm that fits around teaching

Block three short sessions each week for business tasks: one for outreach (messages and calls), one for content (planning and posting), and one for admin (invoices, follow-ups, tracking). Thirty to forty-five minutes each is enough to keep momentum. Protect these slots the way you would protect a class, and review your numbers at the end of each month: new inquiries, trial classes taught, packs sold, clients retained and referrals received.

6. Retention: Keeping the Clients You Win

Keeping a client is usually easier than finding a new one. Retention comes from a few simple habits.

Check-ins

- Greet every client by name and remember one personal detail.
- At the start of class, ask how their body feels today and adapt accordingly.
- Once a month, ask one question: *What would you like more of or less of in class?*

Progress tracking

People stay when they can see their progress. Use the **Client Assessment Form** in the Library at the start, then repeat the same checks every 4 to 6 weeks (for example, a balance hold time, a roll-down range, or how many reps of a given exercise feel controlled). Note the changes and share them. Keep your comments about movement quality and confidence, not medical outcomes.

Use the 8-12 Week Progressive Program

Offering a defined block gives clients a reason to commit. Present the **8-12 Week Progressive Program** in the Library as a structured journey with a beginning and a review. Introduce it after the trial class or the first month. At the end of the block, do a review session using the same assessment checks, celebrate what has changed, and offer the next block.

MOMENT	RETENTION ACTION
Week 1	Welcome message and a clear plan for the first 4 weeks
Week 4	First progress check and a quick feedback question
Week 8	Mid-program review, adapt the plan if needed
Week 12	Final review, celebrate, present the next block
Anytime	Birthday and milestone messages, a note after missed classes

7. A Simple Referral Program

Make it easy and natural to refer a friend. Keep the program simple so you can maintain it.

1. **Decide the reward.** For example, a free class or a small discount on the next pack for the referrer, and a free trial or discount for the friend. Make sure you can afford it.
2. **Write the rules.** Who qualifies, when the reward applies (for example, after the friend's first paid pack), and any expiry date.
3. **Tell clients.** Mention it in class, put a line in your follow-up messages, and keep a printed or digital card ready.
4. **Track it.** A basic spreadsheet with the referrer, the friend, the date and the reward status is enough.
5. **Say thank you** in person and in writing. Recognition matters as much as the reward.

> **Ask at the right moment**
>
> The best time to ask is right after a client shares a positive moment, such as *I feel so much better after class*.

8. Message Templates

Copy and adapt these templates. Replace each [Name] and other bracketed field with the right detail, and keep the tone warm and professional. Always follow local rules on marketing messages and on people's contact preferences.

1. First contact (new inquiry)

Hi [Name], thank you for getting in touch! I teach [class type] at [location]. I would love to learn about what you are looking for. Do you have a few minutes to chat, or would you like to book a trial class? My next openings are [day/time] and [day/time].

2. First contact (introduction to a studio or company)

Hi [Name], I am a certified Pilates instructor with experience in [niche]. I would like to offer a free trial class for your [members/team/staff] to see if it is a good fit. I can work around your schedule, and I have my certification and insurance details ready. Would you be open to a brief conversation this week?

3. Follow-up (no reply)

Hi [Name], I wanted to follow up on my last message. I know things get busy. If you are still interested in a trial class, I have space on [day/time]. If now is not the right time, no problem at all.

4. Trial class reminder

Hi [Name], I am looking forward to seeing you on [day] at [time] at [location]. Please wear comfortable clothes you can move in, bring water, and arrive 10 minutes early. If anything has changed with your health since we last spoke, let me know before class.

5. After the trial class

Hi [Name], thank you for coming today! I really enjoyed working with you, especially [specific detail]. Based on what you told me about [goal], I recommend [package or program]. Would you like me to hold a spot for [day/time]?

6. Follow-up after the trial (no decision)

Hi [Name], I wanted to check in after your trial class. How is your body feeling? If you would like to continue, my [package] is a good way to start. I am happy to answer any questions about schedule or pricing.

7. Welcome new client

Welcome, [Name]! I am excited to start working with you. Your first class is on [day/time]. Here are the details: [location, what to bring, cancellation policy]. Please send me a note if anything changes with your health before then.

8. Missed classes check-in

Hi [Name], I noticed we have not seen you in a few weeks. I hope all is well. If something has changed in your schedule or your body, I am happy to adjust the plan. Would you like to book a class for [day/time]?

9. Re-engagement (inactive client)

Hi [Name], it has been a while, and I wanted to let you know the door is always open. I have a new [class or time slot] that I think you might enjoy. If you would like to return, I would be glad to offer you a [welcome-back class or small incentive]. No pressure, just wanted to say hello.

10. Review request

Hi [Name], I am so glad you have been part of my classes. If you have a minute, an honest review would help others find me. Here is the link: [link]. Thank you so much, and see you in class!

9. A 4-Week Content Calendar

Use this as a repeatable cycle. Each post can be a short video, a photo with a caption, or a text update. Adjust the days to your own schedule.

WEEK	DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3
Week 1: Introduce yourself	Who you help and why (your value proposition)	One exercise cue explained in 30 seconds	Class schedule and how to book a trial
Week 2: Teach	A common movement mistake and a simple fix	A short breathing exercise	Client question answered (no names)
Week 3: Build trust	Behind the scenes: how you plan a class	Your teaching approach and safety first message	A review or thank-you from a client (with permission)
Week 4: Invite	Trial class invitation with details	Package or membership overview	Referral program announcement

After week 4, repeat the cycle with fresh topics. Batch your content once a month so it does not take over your week.

10. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- **Trying to serve everyone.** A vague message is easy to ignore.
- **Underpricing out of fear.** It leads to burnout and attracts bargain hunters rather than regulars.
- **Skipping the follow-up.** Most conversions happen after the second or third touch, not the first.

- **Overloading beginners.** A trial class that is too hard or too long loses clients before they start.
- **Not tracking.** Without numbers you cannot tell what is working.
- **Making health claims.** Never promise to cure, fix or treat any condition. Describe movement and experience, and refer clients to their health professional for medical questions.
- **Promising results.** Use language like *many clients enjoy* or *this class is designed to*, not guarantees.
- **Ignoring paperwork.** Skipping waivers, intake forms or insurance can cost far more than it saves.
- **Posting a lot but never asking.** Visibility without a clear invitation rarely turns into bookings.

11. Legal and Insurance Basics

> **Not legal or tax advice**
>
> This section is general information only. It is not legal, financial or tax advice. Rules differ by country, state and city, so check your local requirements and consult a qualified professional.

- **Liability insurance:** many studios and venues require proof of coverage. Look for professional liability coverage that matches the way you teach (studio, outdoor, online, private).
- **Business registration and permits:** check whether you need to register a business name or hold a permit, especially for teaching in parks or public spaces.
- **Taxes:** if you are self-employed, you may need to track income and expenses and file returns. Ask an accountant what applies to you.
- **Waivers and intake forms:** have clients complete a health questionnaire and a signed waiver. Ask a local professional to review the wording.
- **Scope of practice:** teach movement. Do not diagnose or treat. Refer clients to their health professional for medical questions.
- **Privacy:** store client details securely and ask permission before sharing photos or testimonials.
- **Music licensing:** playing music in classes may require a license in some places. Check what applies to you.
- **Certification and continuing education:** keep your credentials current and keep records of your training.

12. Your 30-Day Action Plan

Tick off each item as you go. If you miss a day, simply carry on. The goal is steady, imperfect progress.

WEEK 1: FOUNDATION

- ☐ Write down your niche and your one-sentence value proposition
- ☐ Calculate your minimum rate using the table in Section 3
- ☐ Set up your 5-pack, 10-pack and membership options
- ☐ Print or save your Client Assessment Form and your waiver
- ☐ Confirm your insurance and any permits you need
- ☐ Complete your Google Business Profile

WEEK 2: OUTREACH

- ☐ List 10 studios, gyms, companies or community spaces to contact
- ☐ Send the first-contact templates to at least 5 of them
- ☐ Message 10 people you know who fit your niche
- ☐ Contact 2 or 3 independent instructors to introduce yourself
- ☐ Schedule your first week of social posts

WEEK 3: TRIAL CLASSES

- ☐ Offer at least 3 trial classes or demo sessions
- ☐ Use the trial class script from Section 5
- ☐ Send the after-class message within 24 hours
- ☐ Follow up with everyone who has not decided
- ☐ Ask each happy client for a review

WEEK 4: RETENTION AND REFERRALS

- ☐ Do a first check-in with each new client
- ☐ Introduce the 8-12 Week Progressive Program to interested clients
- ☐ Launch your referral program
- ☐ Review what worked: messages sent, trials taught, packs sold
- ☐ Plan the next 30 days based on your numbers

Next Step

Pick one item from Week 1 and do it today. Small, consistent actions turn into a steady client base over time. Keep teaching with care, keep learning, and keep the safety of your clients first. Your results will depend on your market, your effort and your time, and you now have a clear plan to start with.